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PROOF WORK DOESN'T PAY UNDER LABOUR

Sickness benefits to be worth **£2,500** a year more than minimum wage job as 'disincentive to work' grows, new report warns

By **Claire Ellicott** Whitehall Editor

LIVING on sickness benefits will soon pay £2,500 a year more than a minimum wage job, it was revealed yesterday.

Earnings of the unemployed who claim ill health payments will overtake those of workers on the national living wage next year, warns a think tank.

The shocking finding comes after Keir Starmer capitulated to a backbench rebellion and failed to secure reforms to the benefits system that would have saved £5billion.

Today, Tory leader Kemi Badenoch will warn Britain faces becoming a 'welfare state with an economy attached' in the face of a rapidly expanding benefits bill.

In a speech on welfare reform she will warn that the country is sitting on a 'ticking time bomb' of spiralling state dependency.

Analysis by the Centre for Social Justice found that a Universal Credit claimant who is not working and takes the average housing



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KATIE HIND

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